B. Read the following text and answer the questions below.

Television Addiction - What is it?

The average person spends about three hours a day sitting in front of the TV set, which is half of their leisure time. And, it is known that heavy viewers report watching eight hours a day. The question is, "Are these people addicted to the television?"

First, let's define an addiction. It is said that addiction is characterized by spending an unusually large amount of time using a substance that is addictive; finding oneself using it more often than intended; thinking about reducing the use and are making repeated unsuccessful attempts to reduce it; giving up social activities to use the substance, and reporting withdrawal symptoms when one does achieve stopping the use.

Most of us like watching TV in the evening. We find it relaxing and fun. It also gives us something to talk about with friends. But, unfortunately, it is possible to watch too much TV. We may even find that we are addicted to the box! Little things, like cancelling an outing with friends in order to stay at home and watch a favourite serial can indicate that TV affects and perhaps controls other areas of your life.

There is probably some kind of correlation between watching a lot of TV and having a deeper problem. Many people are perhaps often just gazing at rather than watching TV. Studies show that people switch on the TV when they are depressed as it helps then tune out bad feelings and push them away for the time being. That is why it is important to really look at the reasons *why* we watching so much TV.

Television Addiction - What are the Effects?

Some studies suggest that TV viewing has a numbing effect, and reaction to the body is likened to that of a tranquilizer. Drowsiness occurs, and one may even experience depression as the viewing continues. A person actually disengages from real life becoming immersed in what is being shown on the screen which, in turn, causes excessive viewing; more so than anticipated in the beginning.



Someone said addiction blurs reality. Watching too much television or for that matter spending too much time on social media can lead to the life lived by TV characters or virtual life becoming more important than the real world we live in and can make us lose touch with reality.

To get TV watching under control you should keep track of the hours that you watch TV, finding alternatives, and developing a mission for your life. This doesn't mean we ban TV from our lives only be conscious of the role it plays in our life and keep it in check.

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